

Suraj Apar

Cybersecurity Student | Offensive Security | SOC & Threat Detection

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[LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#) | [TryHackMe \(Level 10 – Master\)](#) | [Medium Blog](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Entry-level cybersecurity professional pursuing a B.Sc. in Cyber & Digital Science, with demonstrated hands-on skills in penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and web application security. Completed 4 structured TryHackMe learning paths including Junior Penetration Tester, achieving Level 10 Master rank — placing in approximately the top 5% of platform users. Published security research in InfoSec Write-ups (Medium). Proficient in industry-standard tools including Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit Framework, and Wireshark. Seeking an entry-level SOC Analyst, Junior Penetration Tester, or Security Analyst role where hands-on skills and self-driven learning can deliver immediate value.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit Framework (MSF), SQLMap, Hydra, Gobuster, Netcat

Defensive / SOC Tools: Wireshark (packet analysis), log analysis, intrusion detection concepts

Frameworks & Standards: OWASP Top 10, CVE/CVSS scoring

Security Domains: Web Application Security, Network Reconnaissance & Scanning, Windows & Linux Privilege Escalation, Service Enumeration & Fingerprinting, Vulnerability Assessment & Reporting, Security Auditing Fundamentals, Digital Forensics (Introductory), Incident Response Concepts

Operating Systems: Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows

Scripting & Development: Python (automation scripts), Bash (security tooling)

Concepts: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, OSI model, CTF methodology

PROJECTS

File & Directory Integrity Checker — Personal Project

2025

- Engineered a Bash-based cryptographic integrity verification tool that hashes files and directories and flags unauthorized modifications — directly applicable to host-based intrusion detection.
- Automated detection of tampered files using SHA-256 hashing, reducing manual verification effort by ~60–70% (estimated).
- Designed tool output to mirror incident response workflows, producing structured alerts consumable by a SOC analyst during a live investigation.
- Demonstrates core skills: Bash scripting, file system forensics, security automation, and understanding of integrity-based detection.

SECURITY RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Technical Author — InfoSec Write-ups (Medium)

2025

- "Before You Touch Nmap: Networking Fundamentals Every Beginner Must Understand (Part 1)"**
Covers TCP/IP, subnetting, OSI model, DNS, and their application to network reconnaissance — demonstrates foundational knowledge essential for both offensive and defensive roles.
- "Nmap Host Discovery — Finding Targets Without Making Noise (Part 2)"**
Deep dives into stealth scanning techniques, host discovery flags, and minimising detection footprint — demonstrates practical offensive reconnaissance skills.

- **"Host & Network Penetration Testing: System/Host Based Attacks CTF-2 — eJPT (INE)"**

Documents exploitation of Windows and Linux vulnerabilities including privilege escalation and service abuse — demonstrates structured methodology and technical reporting ability.

- **"Vulnerability Assessment CTF-1 — eJPT (INE)"**

Documents web enumeration, hidden endpoint discovery, and vulnerability identification methodology used in a structured assessment simulation.

Technical writing demonstrates ability to produce clear, structured security documentation — a core deliverable in both penetration testing reports and SOC incident reports.

HANDS-ON LAB TRAINING — TRYHACKME

Platform Rank: Level 10 – 0xB [Master] — TryHackMe

2024 – 2025

- Completed Junior Penetration Tester path: reconnaissance, exploitation, post-exploitation, web hacking.
- Completed Web Fundamentals path: OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities (SQLi, XSS, IDOR, broken auth), Burp Suite interception, and web enumeration techniques.
- Completed Cyber Security 101 path: SOC fundamentals, threat intelligence, SIEM concepts, log analysis, and incident triage workflows.
- Completed Pre-Security path: networking (TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP), Linux command line, and Windows Active Directory fundamentals.
- Master rank places in approximately the top 5% of TryHackMe's active user base — demonstrating consistent, measurable skill progression.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst Simulation — Mastercard (via Forage)

2025

- Completed a job simulation modelling the cybersecurity team responsibilities at a global payment technology company.
- Analysed simulated phishing emails to identify social engineering tactics and produced a security awareness training document targeting non-technical employees.
- Assessed organisational security risks and proposed controls — mirroring real-world security analyst workflows.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Junior Penetration Tester, Web Fundamentals, Cyber Security 101 & Pre-Security Learning Paths — TryHackMe | 2025
- Introduction to Cybersecurity — Cisco Networking Academy | 2024
- Cybersecurity Terminology — LinkedIn Learning | 2024

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Cyber & Digital Science — Dr. D.Y. Patil Arts, Commerce & Science College Pimpri , Pune *Expected 2027*
Affiliated to Savitribai Phule Pune University

LANGUAGES

English (Working) | **Hindi** (Working) | **Marathi** (Professional)

All security activities were conducted in legal, authorized, and controlled learning environments.